"INTERPRETING THE UNINTERPRETED: A Controversy Role-Play Series" Group Activity

ACTIVITY OVERVIEW

In this group activity, students will **research**, **analyze**, **role-play**, and **report** the four major historical controversies in Philippine history:

a. **Site of the First Mass: Limasawa or Masao**
b. **Cavite Mutiny**
c. **Retraction of Rizal**
d. **Cry of Balintawak or Pugad Lawin**

Each group will present their assigned controversy through **role-playing** and a **short analytical report**.

GROUP ASSIGNMENT

Divide the class into **four groups**. Each group will focus on one of the following topics:
Group 1: Site of the First Mass
Group 2: Cavite Mutiny
Group 3: Retraction of Rizal
Group 4: Cry of Balintawak / Cry of Pugad Lawin

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. Research Phase (15 minutes)

Each group must research and discuss the following:

- What is the controversy about?
- What are the **conflicting views** or **different versions**?
- Who are the historians involved?
- What evidence supports each side?
- Why is the event important in Philippine history?
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Groups should assign roles:

- **Director/Leader**
- **Scriptwriter**
- **Actors/Performers**
- **Narrator/Reporter**
- **Materials Manager**

A. TIMELINE MAKING (Group Output)

Create a **timeline** showing significant events related to your controversy.
Must include:

- Dates
- Important individuals
- Key turning points
- Short captions

This will serve as visual support for your report.

B. EVIDENCE COMPARISON (Group Discussion)

List the **two or more interpretations** related to the controversy and compare:

- What evidence supports Version A?
- What evidence supports Version B?
- Which version is more credible to the group? Why?

This analysis will be included in the final reporting.

C. ROLE-PLAYING PRESENTATION

Each group must prepare a **20 minute role play** showing the controversy. Your role-play must include:

Elements Required:

✓ **Key historical characters** (e.g., Pigafetta, Magellan, GOMBURZA, Izquierdo, Rizal, Pio Pi, Bonifacio, Valenzuela)
✓ **Conflicting perspectives** (must be shown through the dialogue)
✓ **Historical setting** (you may improvise props)
✓ **Short reenactment** or dramatization of the disputed event

Examples only:

- Group 1 reenacts Pigafetta describing the island while another character argues for Masao. (Site of the First Mass)
- Group 2 shows the Cavite arsenal workers vs Spanish authorities. (Cavite Mutiny)
- Group 3 dramatizes the final hours of Rizal with multiple priests claiming different versions. (Retraction of Rizal)
- Group 4 reenacts the tearing of cedulas with different dates and locations. (Cry of Balintawak or Pugad Lawin)

2. REPORTING & ANALYSIS (After Role Play)

After the performance, the **Narrator/Reporter** will present a **3–5 minute analysis** answering:

1. What is the controversy about?
2. What are the conflicting interpretations?
3. Why do these interpretations differ?
4. What does the group believe is the most credible version? Why?
5. Why is this controversy important in understanding Philippine history?

Use your timeline, chart, or visual aids during the report.

RUBRIC FOR GROUP ACTIVITY
Total: 100 points

Criteria	Excellent *(25–22 pts)*	Proficient *(21–18 pts)*	Developing *(17–14 pts)*	Beginning *(13–10 pts)*
Historical Accuracy & Content Mastery (25 pts)	Information is highly accurate, complete, and clearly explains multiple versions of the controversy; strong understanding of historical context.	Mostly accurate; minor errors but key ideas clearly explained.	Some inaccuracies or missing details; understanding is limited.	Many inaccuracies; major historical points missing or incorrect.
Role-Play Creativity & Delivery (25 pts)	Very engaging, creative, and expressive performance; clearly shows conflicting viewpoints; props/acting strongly enhance presentation.	Good performance; some creativity; shows the key event accurately.	Limited creativity; unclear or incomplete portrayal.	Minimal effort; unclear acting; lacks creativity.
Clarity of Reporting & Analysis (25 pts)	Analysis is clear, logical, and insightful; explains differences in versions and gives well-supported conclusions.	Clear explanation but lacks depth; analysis is present but basic.	Explanation is unclear or shallow; some key points missing.	Very unclear, disorganized, or incomplete analysis.
Visual Aids: Timeline & Evidence Chart (15 pts)	Complete, well-organized visuals that enhance understanding; accurate timelines and comparisons.	Mostly complete; good organization; minor missing details.	Timelines/charts included but unclear or lacking detail.	Incomplete or inaccurate visuals; not helpful.
Teamwork & Participation (10 pts)	All members actively participate; roles are balanced; excellent cooperation.	Most members participate; teamwork is evident.	Uneven participation; some members contribute minimally.	Little teamwork; many members do not contribute.